URBAN HEAT / TWO COOLING PATHWAYS

How trees cool a street.

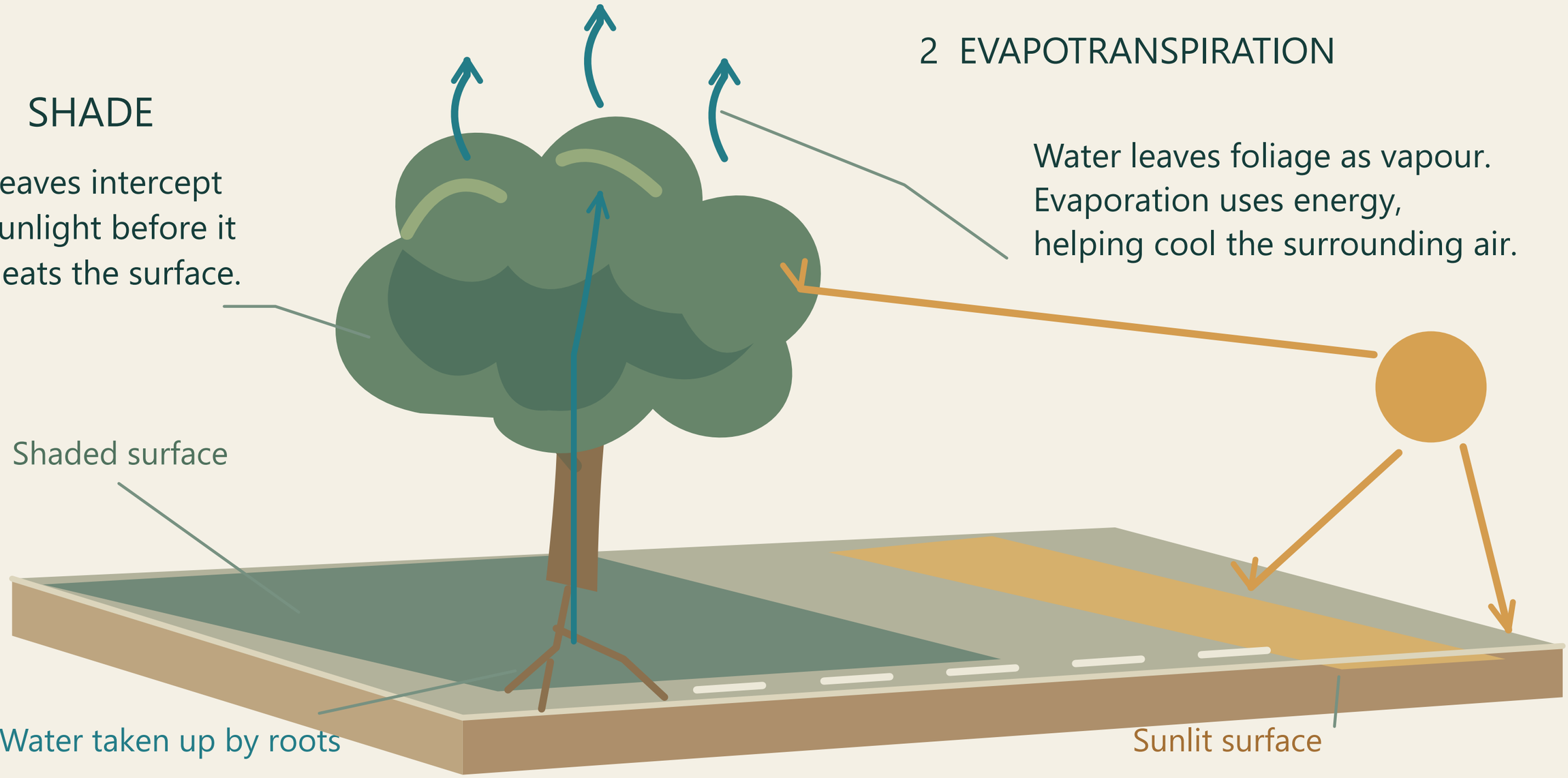
A canopy changes what reaches the ground — and what leaves the tree.

1 SHADE

Leaves intercept sunlight before it heats the surface.

2 EVAPOTRANSPIRATION

Water leaves foliage as vapour. Evaporation uses energy, helping cool the surrounding air.



Cooling varies with tree cover, water availability and local conditions.

Concept diagram | Source: US EPA, Benefits of Trees and Vegetation.